

Thrive Scholars Mentorship Platform

Platform Walkthrough & Spec Coverage

Live app: <https://thrive-scholars.vercel.app>

The 60-second pitch

Thrive Scholars now has an end-to-end mentorship platform that takes a scholar from **sign-up** → **AI match** → **scheduled sessions** → **tracked outcomes**, with a full staff console to manage every step and automations that keep Salesforce and email in sync.

Three roles, three tailored experiences:

- **Scholars** — see their match, book sessions, complete prep, track progress.
- **Volunteers** — accept a mentee, share availability, run and log sessions.
- **Staff / PM** — review and approve matches, manage programs, monitor everything.

Spec coverage

Original requirement	Status	Where to see it
Scholar & volunteer profiles (identity, interests, career, alma mater)	✓ Built	Profile pages; staff detail pages
AI-powered matching with tunable weights	✓ Built	Staff → Programs; Scholar → Run matching
Multiple program types (mentorship, coffee chat, mock interview, resume)	✓ Built	Staff → Programs
PM review & approval workflow	✓ Built	Staff → Matches
Two-sided accept / decline	✓ Built	Scholar & Volunteer → My Matches
Match timeout & escalation	✓ Built	Staff → Matches (timeout banners)
Scheduling (Cal.com)	✓ Built	Volunteer booking link → auto sessions
Interaction tracking (held/missed, ratings, notes)	✓ Built	Sessions pages + Staff → Interactions
Self-service confirmation + reminders	✓ Built	Sessions pages; daily reminder emails
Training / prep content per audience & program	✓ Built	Training pages (incl. Summer Academy)
Session prep guidance & custom comms	✓ Built	Staff → Reminders (templates)
Corporate partner & star-volunteer tracking	✓ Built	Staff → Volunteer detail
Inactivity nudges	✓ Built	Staff → Volunteers (nudge email)
Salesforce sync (contacts, matches, interactions)	● App-ready	Staff → Salesforce; needs SF credentials
Email comms (notifications, reminders, reset)	● App-ready	Works in test mode; needs domain
Automation audit trail	✓ Built	Staff → Automation Log

App-ready = fully built on our side; needs Thrive's credentials/access to go live (Salesforce org + email domain). Nothing more to code — it's a connect step.

Live demo script

Tip: open three browser windows to stay logged in as Staff, Scholar, and Volunteer at once. Staff login: **uyeffe+staff@gmail.com** / **Thrive2026!**. Scholar & volunteer demo accounts use **ThriveTest123!**

Part A — Staff console

Log in as **uyeffe+staff@gmail.com** (password **Thrive2026!**).

- **Dashboard** — high-level overview.
- **Scholars / Volunteers** — rich profiles; volunteer **actions panel** (corporate partner, star, inactivity nudge).
- **Programs** — four program types and the **matching weight sliders** (the tunable AI matching).
- **Run a match** — generate AI suggestions from a scholar's page, then **approve** one.
- **Matches** — status tabs and **timeout escalation** banners.
- **Interactions** — held/missed management and 'send reminder'.
- **Reminders** — a template with merge tags + in-app prep content.
- **Salesforce** — the sync dashboard (linked vs. pending).
- **Automation Log** — every automated event, for audit.

Part B — Scholar experience

Log in as **jordan@test.com**.

- **Home** — welcome, **getting-started checklist**, stats, and 'how mentorship works'.
- **My Matches** — review the mentor, **accept**, then **book a session**.
- **Sessions** — the **prep card** and held/missed self-confirmation + rating.
- **Training** — the Summer Academy video and completion tracking.
- **Profile** — the full editable scholar profile.

Part C — Volunteer experience

Log in as **priya.patel@test.com**.

- **My Matches (landing)** — mentor **getting-started checklist** and 'how mentoring works'.
- **Accept a match**; show the booking-link reminder.
- **Sessions** — prep card + confirm/rate flow from the mentor side.
- **Training & Profile** — volunteer modules, availability, booking link.

Part D — The automations

- **Email**: branded match notices, daily session reminders with prep content, confirmation prompts, password reset.
- **Salesforce**: outbound trigger + writeback endpoint are built; the Automation Log shows events flowing.

What's needed to go fully live

These are **access**, not engineering:

- **Email domain** — verify a Thrive sending domain in Resend (DNS records). ~20 min once DNS access exists.

- **Salesforce** — a connected app / API user + their object model, so Make.com can read/write real records. The app endpoints are ready.

Everything else is built, deployed, and working today.

Security & data privacy

The platform handles scholar PII (including demographic data), so security was built in from the data layer up. Lead with this framing: **access is enforced at the database, not just hidden in the UI.**

How the platform protects data

- **Authentication** — Supabase Auth (industry standard). Passwords are hashed (never stored or seen in plaintext); sessions use signed JWTs; password resets use single-use, time-limited links.
- **Authorization (Row Level Security)** — every table has Postgres RLS policies. Scholars read only their own records; volunteers see only their match context; staff/admin access is gated by a server-side role check. Even a compromised browser session cannot read another user's data — the database refuses it. **Verified by testing:** attempts to read or modify another user's records are rejected at the database.
- **Least-privilege secrets** — the service-role key and all API keys live only in encrypted server-side environment variables, never in the browser. The client uses only the public, RLS-gated key.
- **Transport & hosting** — HTTPS/TLS everywhere (Vercel). Data lives in managed Postgres (Supabase) — encrypted at rest and in transit, with automated backups.
- **Automation & webhooks** — inbound webhooks (Make.com, Salesforce writeback) are verified with HMAC-SHA256 signatures; the scheduled job is protected by a secret. Spoofed calls are rejected.
- **Salesforce exchange** — only record IDs pass over an authenticated channel; no open endpoint dumps PII.
- **Audit trail** — the automation log records every automated action and its success/failure.

Who can see what

Data	Scholar	Volunteer	Staff/Admin
Own profile	✓	✓	✓
Other scholars' PII / demographics	✗	✗	✓
Matched partner's basic context	✓	✓ Match only	✓
All matches / interactions / logs	✗	✗	✓

Security questions you may get

Q: Where is our data and is it encrypted?

A: Managed Postgres on Supabase (built on AWS) — encrypted at rest and in transit (TLS), with automated backups.

Q: Who can see a scholar's personal information?

A: Only the scholar and authorized staff — enforced by database-level Row Level Security, not just the interface. Volunteers never see other scholars' data.

Q: How are passwords handled?

A: Hashed by Supabase Auth; we never store or see plaintext. Resets use expiring, single-use links.

Q: What about the demographic data (race, gender, first-gen)?

A: It powers matching and is access-controlled like all PII; any field can be made optional or omitted per your policy.

Q: Is the Salesforce connection secure?

A: Yes — HMAC-authenticated, ID-only exchange; no open data endpoints.

Q: What if an API key is exposed?

A: Keys are environment-scoped, server-side only, and rotatable without code changes.

Q: Is this FERPA-aware?

A: The access model supports FERPA-style data minimization and need-to-know access; we recommend a formal review with your compliance team before broad rollout.

Honest hardening roadmap (before broad launch)

Frame these as sensible next steps, not gaps that block a pilot:

- Enable **multi-factor authentication** for staff/admin accounts (supported).
- Finish **verified email domain + custom SMTP** (already in progress).
- Add and document a **data-retention & deletion policy**.
- Commission a **third-party security review / penetration test** before scaling.
- Define **backup-restore drills** and an incident-response contact.

Likely questions

Q: Is the matching real AI?

A: Yes — scholar & volunteer profiles are embedded (OpenAI), scored against tunable per-program weights, then surfaced for PM approval. Humans stay in the loop.

Q: What about data in Salesforce?

A: The schema already carries SF IDs on every relevant record, the dashboard tracks sync status, and the writeback endpoint is live. We just need their org credentials to flip it on.

Q: Can staff customize the comms?

A: Yes — reminder templates are fully editable (timing, audience, program, merge tags, prep content) without a deploy.

Q: How do we know sessions actually happened?

A: Both parties self-confirm held/missed, staff can override, and everything is rated and logged.

Salesforce intake & data flow (discussion)

Recent update: the app side of the Salesforce connection is now fully built — both the outbound trigger and the inbound scholar-import endpoint. What remains is configuring Make.com and confirming their data model. Use this to frame the intake conversation.

Talking points

- **Two systems, clear roles** — Salesforce is the system of record (scholars, enrollments, case plans); the platform is the system of engagement (matching, scheduling, sessions, comms). The **sf_*** ID fields keep them linked.
- **Volunteers register on the platform** — they sign up and onboard here (low friction, and we capture exactly what matching needs); Make.com then finds or creates their Salesforce Contact and writes the IDs back.
- **Scholars are imported from Salesforce** — they're existing Thrive participants, so we pull them in rather than re-register them. A new, secure, **idempotent** import endpoint provisions a login + profile and upserts the scholar record (safe to re-run nightly).
- **Recommendation: import program-scoped scholars**, not the entire scholar base — keeps the matching pool relevant and the PII footprint minimal (reinforces the security story).
- **Both directions are coded and dormant** until connected — turning it on is a Make.com configuration step, not new development.

Questions to cover with Thrive

- Should scholars be imported **all** or **program/cohort-scoped**? (We recommend scoped.)
- What **triggers** a scholar import — a nightly sync, or when staff flag a scholar for mentorship in Salesforce?
- Are any **volunteers recruited in Salesforce first** (so we'd also add a volunteer-import path), or always via the platform?
- Which Salesforce **objects and fields** represent scholar enrollment and the case plan we attach interactions to?
- How should imported scholars **get their login** — an invite email, or a 'set your password' link on first contact?
- Who provides the **Salesforce API credentials / connected app**, and who owns the Make.com scenarios?

Prepared for the Thrive Scholars review meeting.